

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Hazy, hot 93/73 • Tomorrow: T-storm 90/74 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, JUNE 12, 2025 • \$4

Pardon frenzy fuels a lucrative industry

Trump's new clemency process unleashes a stampede for attention

BY EMILY DAVIES AND PERRY STEIN

One civil rights attorney seeking clemency for an imprisoned client scored an invite to Mar-a-Lago, then approached President Donald Trump as he dined. An advocate combed through sentencing memos to find details she thought would resonate with the political appointees now in charge. A lawyer flew to Memphis to have lunch at the home of the pardon czar — a position created by the president.

Since taking office in January, Trump has upended the federal pardoning process, increasing the White House's authority over a task that until now was largely governed by Justice Department guidelines. Although many presidents have issued controversial pardons and circumvented their lawyers' advice, Trump has far outpaced his predecessors during the first year of his term and often done so with public flair, relishing one of the few unrestrained powers of the president.

People are making money off the new system. Trump's pardon frenzy has given rise to a lucrative cottage industry of high-powered lawyers connected to the White House who seek his attention on behalf of their convicted clients. In some cases, applicants have hired big-name lawyers who can charge hefty legal fees. In others, clients leverage their own connections to Mar-a-Lago or members

SEE PARDONS ON A4

Tanks in waiting



MATT MCCLAIR/THE WASHINGTON POST

Members of the U.S. Army's 1st Cavalry Division chat on an Abrams tank parked Wednesday at the District's West Potomac Park ahead of Saturday's parade, which will mark the Army's 250th anniversary.

Army parade, protests fuel dueling visions of U.S.

BY NAFTALI BENDAVID

In Washington, tanks will roll down the streets, planes will streak overhead and bands will pump out military tunes as soldiers parade before a president who embraces a gilded, muscular form of patriotism — and whose birthday it is.

Across the country, demonstrators will flood hundreds of cities and towns, making speeches and

holding “No Kings” signs to denounce what they see as President Donald Trump's authoritarian tactics and disregard for the Constitution.

This Saturday will see one of the starkest displays of America's divisions since Trump took office, as contrasting visions of America unfold in vivid colors on the country's streets. The confrontation now playing out in Los Angeles is certain to fuel both sides, as some

Americans cheer Trump's strong hand in quashing purported chaos and others decry what they see as his growing embrace of authoritarian tactics.

Trump's critics are especially inflamed by the notion that the president would host a military parade on his birthday, which they say carries an unmistakable whiff of authoritarianism.

“Americans, in particular veterans, see this as a vanity endeavor

for Donald Trump,” said Rep. Jason Crow (D-Colorado), a former Army ranger who served in Iraq and Afghanistan. “You have massive cuts to [veterans'] health care, troops away from their families for years over the last decade fighting wars on terror, barracks falling apart in many posts — and we will spend over \$50 million to roll tanks through the streets of D.C.? It doesn't add up.”

SEE DIVIDED U.S. ON A6

Worker papers under scrutiny

ICE OFFICES ARE GIVEN AUDIT QUOTAS

Immigration crackdown on employers ramps up

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY, MARIANNE LEVINE AND RACHEL SIEGEL

The Trump administration has ramped up investigations of companies suspected of employing undocumented immigrants, directing officials to meet audit quotas for such reviews to accelerate deportation efforts.

The Immigration and Customs Enforcement division has ordered its 30 regional offices to meet quotas on inspections of employers' documentation of their workers' immigration status, according to three immigration lawyers and a former Department of Homeland Security government official familiar with the agency's operations. The number of notices of inspection, known as I-9 audits, has increased “tenfold” since January, three lawyers said.

The inspections can be a precursor to workplace raids and have recently been used by the Trump administration as a method for detaining undocumented workers without judicial

SEE IMMIGRATION ON A5

Protests' effects: In much of L.A., life is proceeding as usual. A6

Across the U.S.: Demonstrations are spreading to a raft of cities. A7

BRIAN WILSON 1942-2025

Bandleader behind the surfing vibrations of the '60s

He brought an ocean's worth of songwriting depth to the Beach Boys, who embodied California cool

BY TIM PAGE

Brian Wilson, the founder and principal creative force of the Beach Boys, whose catalogue of early hits embodied the fantasy of California as a paradise of beautiful youth, fast cars and endless surf and made them the most popular American rock group of the 1960s, has died at 82.

The family announced the death on his official webpage but did not provide further information.

The Beach Boys were formed in 1961 in Hawthorne, California,

near Los Angeles, by brothers Brian, Dennis and Carl Wilson, their cousin Mike Love and their friend Al Jardine, and the regional success that year of their first single, “Surfin,” thrust them to national attention when Capitol Records signed them almost immediately as the label's first rock act.

They would make the Billboard Top 40 list at least 35 times, a tally unequaled by an American band. While each member contributed to the Beach Boys' signature angelic vocal harmonies, Mr. Wilson was the widely

SEE WILSON ON A20



ILLUSTRATION BY SALLY DENG/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

SERVING ‘DEAD TIME’

D.C. teens needed help. They languished in a violent detention center instead.

BY NICOLE DUNGCA, JOHN D. HARDEN AND KEITH L. ALEXANDER

Washington's juvenile justice agency appeared to finally be reformed. After decades of court monitoring, a judge declared in late 2020 that the long-troubled Department of Youth Rehabilitation Services could return to the mayor's control.

Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) promised “a focus on restorative justice, love, and empowerment” that would “serve and improve the lives of our young people, their families, and our entire community.”

Instead, serious and repeat teen offenders on a better path — unraveled as youth crime spiked, a Washington Post investigation found:

- The agency has taken months to provide many teens with comprehensive treatment plans, violating a law that requires it to do so within 17 days of a judge sentencing a youth to its custody. In fiscal year 2022, the first after the city regained control of the agency, it completed planning for 93 percent of teenagers within three months, according to agency metrics. The next year, less than half had plans in the same time frame.

- The District's detention center, where children are held while they wait for their police, is overcrowded. Fistfights break out often. Police come to quell the violence, while ambulances

SEE DETENTION ON A9



MICHAEL OCHS ARCHIVES/GETTY IMAGES

Singer-songwriter Brian Wilson, founder of the rock group the Beach Boys, holds a mirror reflecting his bandmates circa 1967.

Appreciation: Sunshine music with a haunted sadness was his gift. C1

IN THE NEWS

U.S. on high alert in Middle East The State Department authorized the evacuation of some personnel in Iraq in anticipation of a potential Israeli strike on Iran. A14

‘Distressingly low’ population The diminished number of blue crabs in the Chesapeake Bay raises concerns. B1

THE NATION

After purge, Robert F. Kennedy Jr. picked new members of an influential vaccine panel. A2
Harvey Weinstein was convicted of one count in his sexual assault retrial in New York. A8

THE WORLD

College prep in South Korea now includes cram schools even for kindergartners. A12
Anti-immigrant rioters set fires and attacked police in a town in Northern Ireland. A13

THE ECONOMY

The EPA unveiled proposals that would roll back Biden-era rules on emissions of greenhouse gases and pollution from power plants. A15
Inflation figures for May indicate the U.S. economy's surprising resilience despite the effects of tariffs. A16

THE REGION

Some Virginia Republicans are questioning Lt. Gov. Winsome Earle-Sears's campaign strategy in the race for governor. B1
The former CIA analyst who leaked Israeli military plans was sentenced to three years in prison. B1

STYLE

The president loves “Les Misérables,” a work long embraced by both ends of the political spectrum. C1

LOCAL LIVING

Homesteading can be exhausting and expensive, but one family's attempt turned out to be a happy failure.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A15
COMICS.....C7
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A17
TELEVISION.....C6
WORLD NEWS.....A12

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54245

